

Ceratopsians

The plant-eating ceratopsians varied from sheep-sized animals to sturdy giants that were bigger than elephants. They grazed in the forests and plains of North America and Asia, perhaps in herds. They had huge, parrotlike beaks that they used to grasp and rip up plants. With their towering horns and huge neck frills, they must have been a spectacular sight.



FAMILY FACT FILE

Key features

- Massive hooked beaks for grasping plants
- Hundreds of chisel-edged teeth for slicing through leaves like scissors
- Large horns and neck frills, mainly for display
- Short legs
- Hooflike bones on fingers and toes

When

These dinosaurs thrived in the Cretaceous Period, around 80 million years ago. The last of the ceratopsians died out in the mass extinction at the end of the Cretaceous Period, 65 million years ago.